Advanced Punctuation

Year 5 Accelerated — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Worked examples — tutor talks through these first

Easy: Punctuate the speech: Tom said I am hungry.

Method & answer: Speech marks wrap the exact words; a comma follows the reporting clause. Answer: Tom said, "I am hungry."

Standard: Add a colon to introduce the list: She packed three things a hat a scarf and gloves.

Method & answer: A colon introduces the list, then commas separate the items. Answer: She packed three things: a hat, a scarf and gloves.

Advanced: Join with a semicolon: 'It was raining.' 'We stayed inside.'

Method & answer: A semicolon joins two closely related independent clauses without needing a conjunction. Answer: It was raining; we stayed inside.

Easy / Standard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* ⏱ *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. Punctuate the speech: She said I am tired.

2. Punctuate the speech: Where are you going asked Ben.

3. Does a new line start for a new speaker in dialogue? A) Yes, always B) No, never C) Only if they ask a question D) Only in formal writing

4. Where does the comma go in: "I love this book" said Mia.?

5. Punctuate: he shouted stop right there.

6. Add a colon: There is one thing I want a new bike.

7. Where is the end punctuation (full stop, comma or exclamation mark) placed in relation to the speech marks? A) Always outside B) Always inside C) It depends on the word count D) Only exclamation marks go inside

8. Punctuate: Sam whispered dont wake the baby.

9. Select ALL the punctuation marks that can correctly introduce a list or explanation, e.g. after 'She needed ___': A) colon B) semicolon C) comma D) dash E) full stop

10. Punctuate: the teacher asked who left this here.

11. Does the first word inside speech marks start with a capital letter? A) Yes, always, since it begins the spoken sentence B) No, never C) Only if it's a question D) Only names need capitals

12. Punctuate: yes she said i understand.

13. Add a colon to introduce an explanation: I know why she is upset she lost her purse.

14. Punctuate: he said be careful.

15. How strong is a semicolon compared to a comma and a full stop? A) Weaker than a comma, stronger than a full stop B) Stronger than a comma, weaker than a full stop C) Stronger than both D) Weaker than both

Standard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* ⏱ *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. Punctuate correctly, choosing between a colon and a semicolon: 'There was only one problem ___ nobody had the key.' A) comma B) semicolon C) colon D) dash only

2. Punctuate correctly, choosing between a colon and a semicolon: 'The museum was fascinating ___ we spent all day there.' A) comma B) semicolon C) colon D) full stop

3. Explain why this semicolon use is wrong, and correct it: 'Although it was raining; we still went outside.'

4. Punctuate this sentence containing a nested quotation: 'The teacher said, Remember what Einstein said: Imagination is more important than knowledge.'

5. Punctuate this list, using semicolons because the items already contain commas: 'The recipe needs flour sifted twice sugar caster not granulated and butter softened.'

6. Explain the difference between how a dash and a pair of commas can both set off extra information, using: 'My brother --- always the joker --- laughed loudest.'

7. Which correctly rewrites this reported question? 'He asked could he leave early.' A) He asked if he could leave early. B) He asked, could he leave early? C) He asked: could he leave early. D) He asked; could he leave early.

8. Punctuate the ellipsis correctly to show trailing off: 'I dont know maybe we should just'

9. Select ALL of these sentences that correctly use a colon to introduce a single explanation: A) She had one goal: win the championship. B) She had one goal, win the championship. C) There was only one word for it: magic. D) My favourite hobbies are: reading, painting and chess. E) The museum was fascinating: we spent all day there.

10. Correct this run-on sentence using any appropriate method: 'The bell rang everyone stood up chairs scraped loudly.'

11. Punctuate correctly, including the exclamation mark's position: 'watch out she screamed the ice is cracking'

12. Why is 'My favourite hobbies are, reading, painting and chess.' a common mistake? A) A comma should never appear after 'are' B) It should use a colon or no punctuation at all, not a comma, since 'are' is directly followed by its list C) It needs a semicolon D) It needs a dash

13. Punctuate this sentence with a semicolon to show a strong contrast between two related ideas: 'Some people thrive under pressure others crumble.'

14. Explain why this speech punctuation is wrong, and correct it: 'She said "I'm ready.""

15. Explain the stylistic difference between ending with a colon and ending with a dash to introduce a single dramatic word, using: 'There was only one word for it ___ magic.'

Standard / Hard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* ⏱ *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. Explain the difference in use between a colon and a semicolon.

2. Punctuate, with the speech split

6. Is this colon used correctly: 'The film was terrifying: I couldn't sleep that night.'? Explain.

7. Punctuate: watch out she

11. What is the correct punctuation to introduce direct speech after 'said', 'asked', 'shouted' etc.? A) A colon B) A comma before the opening speech marks C) A semicolon D) No punctuation at all

12. Punctuate: the sign read no

by a reporting clause mid-sentence: I know she said but we must go.

3. What is wrong with 'He had three hobbies, reading, cycling, and painting.'? A) Nothing B) It needs a colon instead of the first comma, to introduce the list C) It needs a semicolon instead of the first comma D) It needs quotation marks

4. Punctuate this list with semicolons because the items contain commas: The teams were Leeds captained by Ana York captained by Ben and Hull captained by Cho.

5. Is it correct to follow a colon with a capital letter when introducing a simple list? A) Yes, always B) Generally no, unless the list items are full sentences or proper nouns C) Only on Mondays D) Only if the list has more than 3 items

screamed theres a car coming.

8. Why is a semicolon (not a comma) needed in 'The museum was closed, we went to the park instead.'? A) A comma alone creates a comma splice joining two independent clauses; a semicolon correctly joins them B) Commas can never join two sentences C) It needs a colon instead D) Nothing is wrong with the comma

9. Punctuate the quotation within a quotation: She said, Mum told me, Be home by six.

10. Correct this run-on: 'The rain poured down, the match was cancelled, everyone went home.'

entry.

13. Select ALL the sentences below where the colon is used INCORRECTLY: A) My favourite fruits are: apples, pears and grapes. B) My favourite fruits are apples, pears and grapes. C) My hobbies include: football and chess. D) She needed one thing: courage. E) The teams were: Leeds, York and Hull.

14. Punctuate: can we go she asked mum replied not yet.

15. Explain the difference between using a dash and a colon to introduce extra information, e.g. 'One thing was certain --- he was late' vs 'One thing was certain: he was late.'